



BY AJAY S. SHRIRAM

India's Incredible Growth Potential

India is on track to becoming an economic superpower by 2029, but some challenges remain. These can be easily overcome

INDIA HAS DISPLAYED exceptional economic stability in a year riddled with volatile commodity shocks and high global food prices. The government, along with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), deserve plaudits for swift and proactive management of inflation.

However, what gives strength to India's economic ambitions is its consistent contribution to the global economy, especially in the aftermath of the Covid-19 pandemic. The country is currently the world's second-largest manufacturer of a range of products, such as mobile phones, steel, cement, pharmaceuticals, and many more. The production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme has been a success for the Make in India initiative, and is expected to attract capex of around ₹1.96 lakh crore over the next few years. This is also reflected in the growth in the contribution of manufacturing to India's GDP during the second quarter of 2023-24.

Agriculture

India's farmers have tilled for decades to feed our growing population, now estimated to be the largest in the world. We are

the world's largest producer of milk and millets, and the second-largest producer of rice, wheat, and sugar.

India's labour-intensive farm sector has seen a steady rise in productivity; as a result, the percentage of employment has reduced to 45% of the working population. Higher farm productivity depends on

adapting innovation at scale. The process has already started in some ways. India's \$30-billion agri-tech industry is connecting the hinterland to hi-tech labs, leveraging climate-smart methods backed by sensor and surveillance technologies, data-driven insights in farming, frugal farming techniques, and

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